



Active listening

Empathy and active listening



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Agenda

- Vocabulary review
- Reading: *Listen up!*
- Listening: Three conversations
- Discussion: The LISTEN model
- Listening: Four conversation
- Speaking: Spot the discrepancies



Reading

- Read the article and answer the questions.
 - In what context are the following statistics mentioned?
 - Do any of them surprise you?
- a) 80%
 - b) 4–5
 - c) 700wpm
 - d) $\frac{3}{4}$
 - e) $\frac{1}{2}$
 - f) 25%
 - g) \$50,000
 - h) \$14,000
 - i) 2:1



Listen up!

Psychologist Eric Berne used to say that everyone in the world just wants to be listened to, but they seldom get what they want because so does everyone else! And this is especially true in the office. Research carried out by the UK leadership institute Roffey Park shows that 80% of managers do not listen well. Part of the problem is that we think four to five times faster than we speak – about 700 words per minute. So no wonder our minds wander the minute someone else opens their mouth!

In their classic book on the subject, *Are You Listening?*, Ralph Nichols and Leonard Stevens estimate that the average employee spends about three-quarters of each working day in conversations with colleagues and clients – roughly half of this time requires them to listen and yet this is a skill at which most are only 25% effective. That means that in the case of an employee earning \$50,000 a year, their company is actually paying them around \$14,000 not to listen! But really bad listeners cost their companies millions more by damaging relationships, missing opportunities and making careless mistakes.

As the ancient Greek philosopher Epictetus wisely reminded us: *"We have two ears and one mouth, so that we can listen twice as much as we speak."*



L.I.S.T.E.N

- One way of making sure you're a good listener is to employ the L.I.S.T.E.N. method.
- With a partner, match the guidelines (a-f) to what you need to do (1-6).

a. Look interested

b. Inquire

c. Summarize

d. Test understanding

e. Encourage

f. Neutralize your own attitudes

1. Seek further information, probe with questions

2. Resist the temptation to judge or criticize too soon

3. Clarify any points which are unclear to you

4. Establish eye contact, adopt an open, alert posture

5. Paraphrase regularly to show you're paying attention

6. Make polite noises, show support, repeat keywords



<https://wordwall.net/play/58420/637/753>

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Four conversations

- Now listen to extracts from four more constructive conversations.
- What's the main topic of conversation and which of the six listening skills is the listener using?



Extract 1

Topic: _____
Skill: _____



Extract 2

Topic: _____
Skill: _____

Extract 3

Topic: _____
Skill: _____



Extract 4

Topic: _____
Skill: _____



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That's all, folks!

